



Notification Waiver Determination

Steamatic Australia – Steamatic Epsom franchisee

Acquisition	Johns Lyng Steamatic Australia Pty Ltd (Steamatic Australia) and Steamatic Restoration and Recovery Pty Ltd (SRR), applied for a notification waiver in respect of SRR's proposed acquisition of an 80% equity interest in Epsom Investment Fund Pty Ltd (Steamatic Epsom), as described in the transaction documents provided as part of the application (the Acquisition).
Determination	The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission has determined under section 51ABV(1)(a) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) that the Acquisition is not required to be notified.
Date of determination	22 September 2026

Parties to the Acquisition	The acquirer, SRR, is a subsidiary of Steamatic Australia. Steamatic Australia is a national provider of restoration services. It has operated in Australia since 1986 under the Steamatic Inc. master franchise. Its network comprises 39 branches nationwide, including five company-owned metropolitan branches in Brisbane, Sydney, Melbourne, Adelaide and Perth, and 34 franchisee-owned regional branches. Steamatic Australia provides water, fire, flood, storm and mould restoration services to home and contents insurers, insurance brokers, loss adjusters, facilities managers and strata corporations. Steamatic Australia is a 96.75%-owned subsidiary of Johns Lyng Group Limited (JLG). JLG is an integrated building services group with operations in Australia and the United States. In Australia, JLG provides building, restoration and disaster management services, together with strata management, essential compliance and home services. JLG's principal activities involve the rebuilding and restoring of properties and contents damaged by insured events and natural disasters, including water, storm, impact and fire events. JLG's customers include major insurers, insurance brokers, loss adjusters, owners' corporations, commercial enterprises, government agencies and retail customers. JLG controls RestorX Services, which supplies preventative and reactive property and contents restoration services across most of Australia for emergency contamination events, including water, fire, soot, mould and odour damage. JLG also acquired Queensland-based Keystone Group in 2024 which provides insurance repairs, restoration and hazardous material removal through its brands Rizon, Remeed Solutions and Corvex. Rizon contracts directly with insurers and insured customers for rebuild and repair projects, while Remeed Solutions principally undertakes restoration works in support of those projects.
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	The target, Steamatic Epsom, is a regional franchisee of Steamatic Australia owned by Gareth Tawton and Brodie Street. Steamatic Epsom owns and operates seven Steamatic branches across regional Victoria, New South Wales and Queensland, namely Steamatic Bendigo, Mildura, Shepparton, Coffs Harbour, Port Macquarie, Bundaberg and Rockhampton.
Explanation for determination	In making this notification waiver determination, the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (the ACCC) has considered the information provided with the notification waiver application and had regard to the factors in section 51ABV(2)(b) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) (the Act). Based on the information currently before it, the ACCC considers that the Acquisition is unlikely to give rise to any material lessening of competition given: a. the increase in share of supply of damage restoration services arising from the Acquisition is expected to be small given the limited geographic scope of Steamatic Epsom’s operations b. there are alternative suppliers of damage restoration services across Australia c. there is a low risk of foreclosure or other concerning vertical or conglomerate effects resulting from exclusionary conduct, bundling or tying post-acquisition. In these circumstances, the ACCC does not consider it necessary to reach a concluded view on the likelihood of the notification thresholds being met. Given that material competition concerns are unlikely to arise, the ACCC has determined that the Acquisition is not required to be notified. The ACCC considers that the determination is consistent with the object of the Act and the interests of consumers in promoting competition. For more information about the ACCC’s approach to considering notification waiver applications and to assessing competition effects more generally, see the ACCC’s guidance on notification waivers and merger assessment guidelines.

Determination made by Commissioner Williams pursuant to a delegation under section 25(1) of the Act